

Reading

Reading

The World's Water Problem

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think the text will be about?
- How much water do you think a family uses in one day?

Water is one of the most important natural resources on Earth, but it is not endless. Although almost seventy percent of the planet is covered with water, only a small part of it is fresh water that people, animals, and plants can use. Most fresh water is locked in ice or deep underground, so the amount that is easily available is actually quite limited.

In many parts of the world, people are already facing serious water shortages. Long periods of drought, growing populations, and wasteful habits are putting pressure on rivers and lakes that used to provide plenty of clean water. In some regions, farmers cannot grow enough food because there simply isn't enough water for their fields, so families are forced to move to cities to find other work.

Factories and farms are also responsible for a lot of water pollution. Chemicals and waste that are dumped into rivers make the water unsafe for drinking, swimming, or fishing. This pollution harms the ecosystems that depend on clean water, and it can take many years for a damaged river to recover.

Fortunately, there are simple actions that can help. Fixing leaking pipes, taking shorter showers, and collecting rainwater are habits that reduce water waste at home. On a larger scale, governments and companies that invest in better water treatment and recycling systems can protect this resource for future generations. Every person who saves water, even a small amount, makes a difference.

1. What percentage of the Earth's surface is covered with water?
 - a. About 30%
 - b. About 50%
 - c. About 70%
 - d. About 90%
2. According to the text, most of the Earth's water is easy for people to use. — *True / False*
3. Why do some farmers move to cities, according to the text?
 - a. They prefer city life.
 - b. There isn't enough water for their fields.
 - c. Cities have better schools.
 - d. Farming is no longer legal.
4. Chemicals and waste dumped into rivers make the water unsafe for drinking, swimming, _____ fishing.

5. Which of these is NOT mentioned as a way to reduce water waste at home?

- a. Fixing leaking pipes
- b. Taking shorter showers
- c. Collecting rainwater
- d. Buying bottled water

6. Rewrite this sentence using a relative clause: 'Governments invest in water treatment systems. These systems can protect this resource.' (Use 'that' or 'which'.)

After you read

- What is one habit from the text that you could start doing at home?
- Do you think water shortages will become a bigger problem in the future? Why?

Saving the Rainforest

Before you read

- What do you already know about rainforests?
- Why do you think rainforests are important for the whole planet?

Rainforests, which cover only a small part of the Earth's land, are home to more than half of the world's plant and animal species. They also produce a large amount of the oxygen we breathe and absorb huge amounts of carbon dioxide, so they play a key role in controlling the planet's climate.

Despite their importance, rainforests are disappearing quickly. Every year, large areas of forest are cut down for wood, farmland, and mining. This process, which is called deforestation, destroys the habitats of countless animals and forces some species closer to extinction. When trees that store carbon are burned or removed, that carbon is released into the atmosphere, so deforestation also makes climate change worse.

People who live near rainforests often depend on them for food, medicine, and their way of life. When the forest disappears, these communities lose resources that they have used for generations. This shows that protecting rainforests is not only about saving animals and plants, but also about supporting the people who call these forests home.

There are hopeful signs, though. Organisations that plant new trees, governments that create protected forest areas, and companies that choose sustainable wood are all part of the solution. Consumers who check where their products come from can also help by choosing goods that do not contribute to deforestation. Small choices, repeated by millions of people, can add up to a big difference.

1. According to the text, what percentage of the world's plant and animal species live in rainforests?

- a. Less than 10%
- b. About 25%
- c. More than half
- d. Exactly 100%

2. Deforestation has no effect on climate change. — True / False

3. Why do some local communities lose important resources when the forest disappears?

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- a. They move to other forests.
- b. They depend on the forest for food, medicine, and their way of life.
- c. They no longer need natural resources.
- d. The government gives them new land.

4. Every year, large areas of forest are cut down for wood, farmland, _____ mining.

5. Which group is NOT mentioned as part of the solution?

- a. Organisations that plant trees
- b. Governments that create protected areas
- c. Companies that choose sustainable wood
- d. Airlines that offer cheaper flights

6. Combine using 'so': 'Trees store carbon. Burning trees releases that carbon into the air.' (*Cause first, then 'so'.*)

After you read

- Which solution from the text do you think is the most effective? Why?
- What could you personally do to help protect rainforests?